

## **02. Cancer Symptoms**

### **Introduction**

Cancer symptoms vary depending on the type, size, location, and stage of the disease. Some cancers may not cause symptoms in the early stages, making regular screening important.

### **General Symptoms**

Common symptoms include unexplained weight loss, persistent fatigue, fever, night sweats, pain that does not improve, loss of appetite, persistent cough, unusual bleeding, and lumps or swelling.

### **Breast Cancer Symptoms**

A lump in the breast or underarm, changes in breast size or shape, nipple discharge, skin dimpling, redness, swelling, or nipple inversion.

### **Lung Cancer Symptoms**

Persistent cough, coughing up blood, chest pain, shortness of breath, hoarseness, frequent chest infections, and unexplained weight loss.

### **Colon Cancer Symptoms**

Blood in the stool, changes in bowel habits, abdominal pain, constipation or diarrhea, fatigue, and unexplained weight loss.

### **Prostate Cancer Symptoms**

Frequent urination, difficulty starting urination, weak urine stream, blood in urine or semen, and pelvic discomfort.

### **Cervical Cancer Symptoms**

Abnormal vaginal bleeding, bleeding after intercourse, pelvic pain, and unusual vaginal discharge.

### **When to Seek Medical Advice**

Consult a healthcare professional if symptoms persist for more than two weeks, worsen over time, or include unexplained bleeding, a growing lump, severe pain, or significant weight loss. Early diagnosis improves treatment outcomes.

### **Summary**

Many cancer symptoms overlap with other conditions. Only a qualified healthcare professional can diagnose cancer through appropriate tests and examinations.